

Ross Tax Pro University of Business, Accounting and Taxation

Controlled Governance and Academic Document Index

****Document class:**** Institutional governance master set

****Status:**** Draft for board, counsel, academic, regulatory, and accreditation review

****Control rule:**** No document is official until its required approver, approval date, effective date, version, and superseded-document record are entered in the controlled repository.

Governance set

1. University Charter and Articles Framework
2. Board of Trustees Bylaws
3. University Governance Manual
4. Presidential Directives and Executive Orders Standard
5. Five-Year Strategic Plan, 2027-2031
6. Mission, Vision, Values and Institutional Commitments
7. Organizational and Delegation-of-Authority Model
8. Annual Institutional Report Standard
9. Risk Management and Internal Controls Manual
10. Institutional Policies Handbook
11. Records Retention and Archiving Policy
12. FERPA and Student Records Policy
13. ADA, Section 504 and Digital Accessibility Policy
14. Title IX Policy and Procedures
15. Safety, Emergency Response and Continuity Plan
16. Data Governance and Privacy Policy
17. LMS, SIS, Identity and IT Security Policy
18. Accreditation Self-Study Readiness Report
19. Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment Plan
20. Academic Progress, Attendance, GPA and Accountability Policy
21. Online Bookstore, EPUB and Course Resource Policy
22. Curriculum Resource, Assessment and Proctoring Standard

23. Student Services Department Operations Manual

24. University Personnel, Communications and Document Control Manual

Academic affairs set

Academic catalog; school and department handbooks; curriculum committee charter and minutes; course and program approval forms; syllabus template; faculty credentialing standard; academic integrity, grading, standing, credit-hour and distance-learning policies; program and course outcomes; rubrics; academic calendar; online-course development standard; and faculty evaluation framework.

Program and registrar set

Every program file contains overview, authority status, admissions, completion, plan of study, sequence, handbook, practicum, capstone, competencies, assessment plan, disclosure statement, and any applicable specialized-accreditation evidence. Registrar controls cover the SIS, education-record access, transcript design, corrections, holds, enrollment reporting, transfer credit, graduation audit, conferment, credential numbering, verification, retention, and disaster recovery.

Required approval metadata

- Document code and title
- Version and effective date
- Draft owner and policy steward
- Legal review status
- Shared-governance consultation
- Executive or board approval
- Regulatory/accreditation evidence
- Publication location
- Review date and change history
- Superseded version and retention disposition

Charter, Bylaws and Governance Manual

Charter and articles framework

The institution is proposed as a separately governed educational operation of Ross Tax Pro Software Co. Its purposes are online education in business, accounting, taxation, technology, leadership, adult education, and related fields; scholarly and applied inquiry; community economic advancement; and lawful certificate, diploma, and degree activity only within documented authority.

The final articles must identify the legal entity, registered agent, principal office, lawful nonprofit or for-profit character, governing law, member/shareholder relationship if any, board powers, educational purpose, limitations, conflicts, indemnification, dissolution, records custody, and amendment method. Corporate counsel must reconcile the articles with the parent entity and every state in which students are enrolled.

Board of Trustees bylaws

The Board holds fiduciary responsibility for mission, integrity, executive oversight, financial sustainability, risk, academic quality, truthful public representation, and preservation of institutional records. It does not direct individual grading or admissions decisions except through approved policy and appeal authority.

Composition and independence

The Board should include finance/accounting, higher education, legal/compliance, technology/cybersecurity, workforce, student-success, and community expertise. A majority-independent standard is recommended. Terms, removal, vacancies, compensation, annual disclosure, background review, and succession are recorded.

Committees

- Executive and Governance
- Academic Quality and Student Success
- Audit, Risk, Finance and Compliance
- Technology, Data and Cybersecurity
- Nominations, Compensation and Executive Evaluation

Meetings

Regular meetings occur at least quarterly. Notice, agenda, quorum, recusal, executive session, voting, minutes, written consent, remote participation, emergency action, and record retention follow adopted bylaws. Minutes record deliberative outcomes without exposing protected student, employee, legal, or security information.

Shared governance

The Board reserves charter, presidential appointment, mission, strategy, budget, risk appetite, degree authority, major program approval, tuition, and closure decisions. The President administers the institution. The Provost and Academic Council govern curriculum and academic standards subject to Board authority. Faculty own course-level academic judgment. The Registrar owns official academic records. Compliance officers retain independent escalation access to the Audit and Risk Committee.

Presidential directives

Directives use a unique number, authority citation, scope, findings, operative clauses, accountable executive, effective date, expiration/review date, fiscal and technology impacts, consultation record, and signature. Emergency directives expire within 90 days unless ratified.

Mission and vision

Mission: Deliver rigorous, accessible, technology-enabled education in business, accounting, taxation, and leadership that advances ethical practice, economic mobility, community wealth, and public trust.

Vision: Become a distinguished online institution known for HBCU-centered excellence, applied scholarship, responsible AI, student support, and graduates prepared to lead with competence and conscience.

Values: truth; intellectual rigor; access; cultural dignity; stewardship; service; privacy; accountability; due process; innovation; and human responsibility.

Five-year strategic plan, 2027-2031

- Authority and integrity:** secure applicable state authority; establish truthful disclosures; prepare accreditation eligibility without premature claims.
- Academic excellence:** approve coherent programs; credential faculty; build original/OER coursebooks; assess learning and close improvement loops.
- Student access and completion:** deploy accessible advising, early alerts, tutoring, complaint resolution, and measurable persistence interventions.
- Digital trust:** operate secure LMS/SIS/identity services, privacy governance, incident response, resilience, and responsible AI oversight.
- Sustainable growth:** maintain audited budgets, enrollment scenarios, reserves, teach-out capacity, workforce partnerships, and transparent outcomes.

Annual key results include approval milestones, course-review completion, learning-outcome attainment, retention, complaint resolution, accessibility remediation, faculty evaluation, security exercises, audit findings, and financial-reserve thresholds. Targets require Board adoption after baseline data exists.

Organization

Board of Trustees → President → Provost/Academic Affairs; Finance and Administration; Student Affairs and Enrollment; Registrar; Institutional Effectiveness and Accreditation; Legal, Risk and Compliance; Technology and Digital Learning; Advancement and Community Engagement.

Academic Affairs → School of Business and Accounting; School of Taxation and Professional Practice; School of Adult and Secondary Education; General Education; Library and Learning Resources; Center for Teaching, Assessment and Responsible AI.

Institutional Policies Handbook

Policy governance

Policies follow proposal, impact review, stakeholder consultation, legal/compliance review, approval, publication, training, monitoring, review, revision, and retirement. Exceptions require documented authority, reason, duration, compensating controls, and approval. No AI agent may approve policy or an exception.

Risk and internal controls

The institution uses an enterprise risk register covering authority/accreditation, academic quality, enrollment, student protection, financial sustainability, privacy, cybersecurity, accessibility, civil rights, vendors, continuity, records, and reputation. Each risk has inherent rating, controls, owner, residual rating, indicators, treatment, due date, and assurance evidence.

Control design uses segregation of duties, least privilege, dual approval, reconciliations, immutable audit events, vendor due diligence, change management, backups, recovery tests, incident escalation, and quarterly management certification. Material control failures reach the Audit and Risk Committee without management interference.

Records retention and archiving

The records schedule distinguishes permanent governance and credential records; long-term academic and financial records; time-limited applications, assessments, complaints, accommodations, investigations, contracts, security logs, and operational data; and legal holds. Destruction requires an expired schedule, absence of hold, owner authorization, auditable disposition, and secure deletion. Retention periods are finalized by counsel against applicable federal, Texas, accreditor, contractual, and limitation requirements.

FERPA and education records

If and when FERPA applies, eligible students receive annual notice and rights to inspect records, request amendment, consent to disclosure, and complain to the U.S. Department of Education. Access is limited to authenticated officials with legitimate educational interest. Disclosures rely on consent or a documented exception, and required disclosure records are maintained. Directory information is not designated until a separate notice, opt-out process, data inventory, and risk review are approved.

The institution will apply equivalent privacy controls contractually even before federal funding status is resolved. FERPA is not a cybersecurity standard; security, minimization, encryption, retention, vendor, and incident controls remain separately required.

ADA, Section 504 and accessibility

Programs are designed for equivalent access. The institution appoints an accessibility coordinator; publishes a request and grievance process; provides reasonable modifications and auxiliary aids; conducts individualized review; prohibits retaliation; and offers accessible alternatives without lowering essential academic requirements. Digital content targets WCAG 2.2 AA, subject to legal review and applicable requirements. Procurement requires accessibility documentation and testing.

Title IX and nondiscrimination

The institution prohibits sex discrimination where applicable, appoints a qualified Title IX Coordinator before operation, publishes contact and reporting channels, uses prompt and equitable procedures under the then-current binding regulations, provides supportive measures, addresses conflicts and retaliation, preserves impartial decision-making, and trains relevant personnel. Counsel must verify the controlling rule before adoption; legal templates are not frozen into software.

Safety, emergency response and continuity

The plan covers online threats, self-harm/welfare escalation, identity compromise, cyber incidents, severe weather affecting operations, workplace emergencies, vendor outage, loss of records, and communication failure. It defines incident command, emergency contacts, severity, notification authority, accessibility, continuity priorities, backup channels, recovery objectives, exercises, after-action review, and corrective action.

Clery applicability depends on institutional and Title IV facts and any covered geography. The institution will not publish invented crime statistics or claim Clery compliance without a documented determination and required evidence.

Data governance and privacy

Data are classified public, internal, confidential, restricted, and regulated. Owners define purpose, lawful basis, fields, minimum access, retention, sharing, lineage, quality, and disposition. Sensitive student, identity, disability, financial, and disciplinary information is excluded from AI prompts by default. Cross-tenant access is denied server-side.

IT security for LMS, SIS and identity

Mandatory controls include managed identities, MFA, organization-scoped RBAC, privileged-access review, encryption in transit and at rest, key rotation, secure SDLC, dependency and secret scanning, logging with redaction, vulnerability management, tested backup/recovery, incident response, vendor review, session revocation, device and administrator safeguards, immutable audit correlation, and annual tabletop testing.

AI systems operate server-side with approved sources, prompt limits, redaction, rate limits, human review, model/vendor inventory, evaluation, misuse monitoring, and a kill switch. They cannot confer credentials, decide discipline, approve accommodations, disclose records, or make final admissions/employment decisions.

Academic Affairs Manual

Academic authority

The Provost is accountable for academic quality. The Academic Council recommends policy. Curriculum committees review programs and courses using academic need, authority, learning coherence, faculty capacity, library/resources, accessibility, assessment, technology, financial sustainability, student protection, and teach-out criteria. Board approval is required for new degrees, material mission change, and other reserved matters.

Curriculum committee records

Minutes record meeting number, date, attendance, quorum, recusals, agenda, proposal identifiers, evidence reviewed, motions, votes, conditions, effective term, responsible owner, and follow-up. Student-specific information and privileged advice are excluded from public minutes. Approved minutes are immutable; corrections are appended.

Course approval form

- Proposal ID, academic unit, proposer and effective term
- Course code, title, level, credits/contact hours and delivery mode
- Catalog description, prerequisites/corequisites and repeatability
- Rationale, program mapping, PLO/CLO alignment and curriculum map
- Weekly instructional-time calculation and student-work estimate
- Required faculty qualifications and support capacity
- Coursebook/OER/library resources and copyright clearance
- Assessments, rubrics, mastery thresholds and integrity controls
- Accessibility review and alternative formats
- Technology, privacy, AI, proctoring and vendor impacts
- Budget, teach-out and implementation plan
- Department, curriculum committee, Provost and regulatory approvals

Program approval form

Adds market/student need, award level, CIP/SOC mapping, admission and completion rules, term-by-term plan, transfer assumptions, faculty roster, library analysis, facilities/technology, student services, learning outcomes, assessment plan, enrollment and financial projections, refund/cancellation terms, complaint process, authorization/accreditation analysis, licensure disclosure, teach-out, records custody, and external review.

Syllabus standard

Every syllabus includes institution and course identity; instructor and support contacts; description; credits/contact hours; prerequisites; outcomes; required resources; weekly schedule; assessments and weights; grading scale; attendance/participation; late/recovery rules; integrity and AI-use rules; accessibility and accommodation route; nondiscrimination/Title IX reporting; privacy; technical requirements; communication expectations; complaint/appeal route; and change-control statement.

Faculty credentialing

Files include identity verification, CV, official transcripts obtained securely from issuing institutions, licenses/certifications where required, subject-matter rationale, teaching evidence, professional experience, references, background determination when lawful, annual disclosure, appointment scope, evaluation, development, and separation date. Equivalent-experience decisions require written rubric, independent review, and Provost approval. AI personas are not faculty of record.

Credit hour assignment

Credit is based on verified student learning and an approved equivalency methodology—not seat time alone. Each proposal documents instructional interaction, independent work, assessments, expected time, modality, accelerated-term equivalence, and periodic validation using learner analytics and faculty review. No credit is assigned merely for AI conversation or platform activity.

Distance learning

Online courses require regular and substantive interaction as applicable, authenticated participation, accessible content, qualified faculty oversight, orientation, technical support, identity verification, privacy notice, predictable response standards, academic engagement records, and equivalent outcomes. Any identity-verification charge must be disclosed before enrollment.

Academic integrity

Prohibited conduct includes unauthorized assistance, fabrication, plagiarism, impersonation, collusion, tampering, and misuse of protected assessment content. Permitted AI use is stated per assessment. Detection tools create signals, not findings. Students receive notice, evidence, response opportunity, impartial human review, proportionate outcome, and appeal. Records are access-limited and retained under schedule.

Grading and standing

Faculty-approved rubrics govern grades. Objective automation is reviewed statistically and contestable. Incomplete, withdrawal, repeat, grade correction, academic warning, probation, suspension, dismissal, reinstatement, and appeal rules use published thresholds and due process. Satisfactory academic progress for federal aid remains disabled until Title IV authority and an approved SAP policy exist.

Faculty evaluation

Annual evaluation considers teaching effectiveness, student learning, course stewardship, timely feedback, accessibility, professional development, service, scholarship/practice, integrity, and improvement commitments. Student ratings are one source and never the sole determinant. The faculty member may respond and appeal.

Academic calendar

The Registrar publishes application, registration, add/drop, census, withdrawal, assessment, grade, conferment, holiday, and appeal dates only after operational and regulatory approval. Changes preserve instructional equivalence and student notice.

Standard institutional rubric

- Advanced (4): accurate, integrated, source-grounded, ethical, transferable application
- Proficient (3): accurate and complete with supported application
- Developing (2): partial accuracy or weak support requiring revision
- Beginning (1): major gaps, unsupported claims, or unsafe application
- No evidence (0): missing, nonresponsive, or unverifiable

Programs define measurable PLOs in disciplinary knowledge, inquiry, communication, quantitative/digital fluency, ethical judgment, cultural/community responsibility, and applied integration. Courses map CLOs to PLOs and identify introduced, reinforced, and mastered levels.

Degree, Certificate and Mandated-Program Document Standard

Every program receives one controlled master file containing the following sections.

Program overview

Official title, award, school/department, delivery mode, CIP/SOC if applicable, purpose, audience, authority status, accreditation status, truthful disclosure, program length, credits/hours, costs, occupational claims, and effective catalog year.

Admission requirements

Published academic prerequisites, age/education evidence, identity process, language/technology readiness, transfer/advanced-standing rules, essential requirements, nondiscrimination, accommodations, deadlines, fees, decision authority, reconsideration, and privacy notice. Criminal-history or licensure barriers may be stated only after legal review.

Completion requirements

Minimum credits/hours, required courses, grades/GPA, residency, practicum, capstone, competency assessment, time limit, financial/records clearance, conduct standards, application for completion, and human conferment approval.

Pathway map and sequence

Term-by-term sequence identifies prerequisites, co-requisites, milestones, assessments, work-integrated learning, electives, stop-out/reentry points, and stackable awards. Published plans include a disclaimer that course availability and external transfer are not guaranteed.

Practicum or internship

Site agreement, qualified supervisor, learning contract, hours/activity log, safety, confidentiality, accessibility, insurance where applicable, background checks where lawful, evaluation, incident reporting, complaint route, and alternative placement. Tax practicums use synthetic data until client-data authority is separately approved.

Capstone

Students integrate program outcomes through an authentic project, source-based analysis, portfolio, presentation, and oral defense. Faculty approve topic, ethics/privacy plan, rubric, authorship evidence, revision, and final result.

Assessment plan

For every outcome: direct measure, benchmark, sample, collection point, responsible faculty, disaggregation rules, analysis date, finding, action, owner, completion date, and reassessment. Small-cell suppression protects privacy. Results improve the program and are not manufactured for accreditation optics.

Court-mandated or externally required programs

No program is marketed as court-approved, probation-approved, state-approved, or satisfying an order without written recognition from the controlling authority. Attendance verification uses authenticated activity plus substantive work; completion certificates include program version, verified hours, identity method, issuer, and limitations. Staff never promise acceptance by a court or agency.

Program handbook contents

Welcome; contacts; outcomes; plan; academic expectations; technology; attendance/engagement; grading; integrity/AI; practicum/capstone; advising; accessibility; nondiscrimination; privacy; complaints; appeals; conduct; costs/refunds; records/transcripts; completion; external credential disclosures; safety; teach-out; and acknowledgment.

Specialized accreditation

The file identifies whether specialized accreditation is required, optional, unavailable, or not applicable. Evidence includes eligibility correspondence, standards crosswalk, self-study, exhibits, site/virtual review, decision letter, conditions, monitoring, public disclosure, and renewal. “Accredited” appears only after a recognized accreditor issues a current decision covering the institution/program.

Registrar, SIS and Transcript Policy

Authority and records

The Registrar is custodian of the official academic record and controls term, course, enrollment, grade, credit, standing, completion, conferment, transcript, verification, and records-correction processes. Faculty submit grades; only authorized Registrar workflows post or correct the official record. Administrators and AI tools cannot silently overwrite it.

SIS minimum record

Institution and tenant; student identifier; verified legal name and approved chosen/preferred name; contact and identity-verification status; admission basis; program/catalog year; term/enrollment status; course section; modality; credits attempted/earned; grade; repeat/withdrawal/incomplete indicators; transfer source/evaluation; GPA; academic standing; holds; completion audit; award; conferment date; credential ID; transcript events; consent/disclosure log; corrections; and audit correlation.

Sensitive identity documents, disability records, conduct evidence, financial-aid files, and authentication secrets are segregated from the ordinary academic record with narrower access.

Transcript format

Official transcripts display institutional legal name and authority disclosure; document legend; student name and identifier sufficient for matching without exposing SSN; issue date; attendance dates; program/major; courses by term; credits; grades; GPA; transfer summary; academic standing where policy permits; awards and conferment date; authentication/security feature; Registrar attestation; and transcript key.

The transcript legend defines calendar, credit unit, grading scale, repeat/withdrawal/incomplete marks, GPA rules, transfer credit, academic level, delivery notations if used, accreditation/authorization statement, and authenticity verification. Proposed programs cannot generate an “official” transcript or degree notation before authority and board gates pass.

Issuance and verification

Requests require authenticated identity, consent where applicable, fee disclosure, hold analysis under applicable law, delivery choice, recipient confirmation, and audit event. Electronic transcripts use an approved secure network or signed document with expiration and tamper evidence. Email attachments are not the default secure method.

Corrections and appeals

Clerical corrections require source evidence and dual control. Grade changes require faculty/academic authority and reason. Historical changes append an immutable event and preserve prior value. Students receive published review and appeal routes. No record is changed to satisfy an employer, court, lender, or other third party without lawful authority.

Conferment gate

The graduation audit verifies program/catalog, credits, residency, GPA, required courses, practicum/capstone, academic and conduct status, record accuracy, applicable financial clearance, institutional/program authority, and human approval. Credential numbering occurs only after approval. Revocation requires counsel-reviewed grounds, notice, evidence, hearing/response opportunity, final human decision, and permanent audit record.

Reporting and clearinghouse

Enrollment, completion, DegreeVerify, DiplomaVerify, NSLDS, state, and accreditor files remain disabled until the institution has applicable authority, contracts, identifiers, specifications, privacy basis, tested secure transport, reporting calendar, certified owners, acknowledgement reconciliation, correction procedures, and incident response. Every batch is hashed, validated, approved, transmitted once, acknowledged, reconciled, and archived.

Retention and continuity

Award, conferment, transcript, and credential-verification records are designated permanent unless counsel approves a different lawful schedule. The institution maintains encrypted backups, geographic resilience, restoration testing, successor custodian/closure arrangements, and a teach-out records plan.

Accreditation Readiness and Institutional Effectiveness Plan

Self-study status

This is a readiness framework, not an accreditation self-study submitted to or accepted by an accreditor. The institution has not supplied evidence of eligibility, candidacy, accreditation, degree authority, Title IV participation, or specialized program accreditation. All public claims remain blocked until decision letters are verified.

Evidence domains

1. Mission, integrity and public information
2. Governance, autonomy and conflicts
3. Legal authority and institutional identity
4. Academic programs, rigor and credit
5. Faculty sufficiency and qualifications
6. Student admission, support, complaints and achievement
7. Library, learning and technology resources
8. Financial capacity, audit, reserves and teach-out
9. Institutional effectiveness and continuous improvement
10. Distance education, identity, privacy and accessibility
11. Responsible AI and human academic accountability
12. Records, disclosures, consumer protection and regulatory compliance

Each standard has a narrative, requirement crosswalk, evidence owner, verified exhibit, finding, gap, corrective action, deadline, validation method, and approval.

Effectiveness cycle

Mission → strategic goals → program outcomes → course outcomes → curriculum and service delivery → direct/indirect evidence → analysis → decision → funded improvement → implementation → reassessment → public/accountable reporting.

Annual institutional report

The report includes authority/accreditation status; governance actions; enrollment and applicant funnel; student composition using privacy-safe reporting; retention, progression, completion and time-to-award; course success and

learning outcomes; complaints and appeals; accessibility; faculty sufficiency; library use; workforce/transfer outcomes with methodology; financial statements and sustainability; audits; cybersecurity and continuity exercises; risks; strategic-plan progress; and improvement commitments.

No rate is published without a defined cohort, denominator, period, exclusions, source system, reconciliation, privacy review, and responsible owner. No employment, salary, transfer, licensure, or completion outcome is guaranteed.

Assessment governance

Institutional Effectiveness maintains the assessment calendar and evidence repository. Programs report annually; general education and administrative units follow an approved cycle. The Academic Council reviews learning evidence, executive leadership assigns resources, and the Board reviews institutional outcomes and risk. AI may summarize validated evidence but cannot invent findings or close actions.

Readiness decision

Launch is blocked until authority, governance, audited financial capacity, academic staffing, student protection, technology/security, library resources, truthful catalog, complaint/appeal, records custody, accessibility, and teach-out controls are verified. Accreditation pursuit requires a Board-approved accreditor strategy and written eligibility confirmation.

Academic Progress, Attendance, GPA, and Accountability Policy

****Control status:**** Draft for faculty, Registrar, accessibility, legal, and Board review. Not effective until adopted.

Academic record and real-time presentation

The SIS maintains term, section, enrollment, assignment, submission, grade, attendance, degree-audit, intervention, appeal, and decision records. Every material change carries actor, timestamp, source, reason, version, tenant, and correlation data. “Real time” means event-driven display of the latest committed record; unverified activity is not an official grade or attendance event.

GPA and grade controls

Unless an adopted catalog rule provides otherwise, A=4, B=3, C=2, D=1, and F=0 quality points. GPA is quality points divided by GPA credits and displayed to three decimals. Pass, no-pass, incomplete, and withdrawal records do not contribute quality points. Only authorized instructors or academic reviewers may approve grades. AI may provide formative feedback but cannot assign a final grade, alter the gradebook, decide an integrity allegation, or decide an appeal.

Attendance, schedules, and expectations

Attendance evidence may be a verified live-session check-in, faculty verification, or meaningful academic activity; login alone is insufficient. The official schedule identifies timezone, modality, meetings, assessment windows, and deadlines. Degree audits distinguish earned, in-progress, planned, repeated, transferred, excluded, and required credits. Expected completion is an estimate, never a promise.

Accountability and due process

Versioned rules may flag low averages, attendance concerns, missed work, inactivity, GPA thresholds, pace, or integrity concerns. A flag creates a human support/review task. It cannot automatically withdraw, fail, suspend, penalize, or withhold a credential. Before adverse action, the student receives notice, evidence access, response opportunity, accommodation review where applicable, a reasoned human decision, and an appeal route.

Draft thresholds are below 70% assignment average, below 80% verified attendance, and below 2.000 cumulative GPA. These are not enforceable until adopted and published for the applicable program and catalog year.

Privacy and operational state

Students may view their records; faculty access is limited to assigned sections; Registrar and staff access follows job duty. Exports are logged and tenants isolated server-side. Code and schema may be configured before the SIS, queue, and notification infrastructure are operational. No live claim is permitted without end-to-end verification.

Online Bookstore, EPUB, and Course Resource Policy

****Control status:**** Draft for academic, accessibility, copyright, finance, tax, privacy, and Board review.

Course materials must be mapped to an approved course and term. Each resource records format, edition, requirement level, accessibility validation, copyright or open-license basis, price, provider, availability, and review date. Students must see multiple lawful options when available: institution-included materials, open educational resources, publisher-direct access, authorized rental, and authorized print-on-demand.

Institution-authored EPUB releases must use EPUB 3, semantic structure, navigation, alternative text, reading order, language metadata, accessible tables and mathematics, and validation before publication. Source, build artifact, rights record, accessibility report, version, and hash remain controlled records.

The storefront separates catalog discovery, entitlement, order, payment, fulfillment, refund, and support states. No resource is represented as licensed or available until rights and fulfillment are verified. No paid checkout is enabled until merchant-of-record, sales-tax, pricing, refund, payment-security, reconciliation, accessibility, privacy, and customer-support controls pass production review. AI may recommend mapped resources but cannot purchase, change prices, grant paid entitlements, or assert copyright permission.

Curriculum Resource, Assessment, and Proctoring Standard

****Status:**** Draft. Faculty, assessment, accessibility, privacy, academic-integrity, legal, and Board approval required.

Each approved course owns a curriculum map linking every course learning outcome to instruction, textbook chapters, workbooks, references, software, supplies, assignments, quizzes, discussions, case studies, practical work, midterm, final, optional extra credit, and program outcomes. Costs, licenses, accessibility, prerequisites, instructional minutes, expected student effort, and assessment weights are disclosed before enrollment.

221-item bank standard

Each course maintains a target bank of 221 independently reviewed items: 55 single-choice, 35 multiple-select, 30 calculations, 30 applied scenarios, 20 case analyses, 20 short responses, 12 writing tasks, 10 structured discussions, 6 practical/workbook items, and 3 oral defenses. This is a bank, not a requirement that one exam contain 221 questions. Faculty select an appropriate form through an approved blueprint measuring outcomes and cognitive levels without excessive testing burden.

Every item stores outcome, cognitive level, type, difficulty, rationale, authoritative citations, scoring key or rubric, accessibility review, version, author, reviewer, exposure status, and psychometric results. AI-drafted items remain drafts until subject-matter and assessment faculty approve them. Live answer keys are encrypted and never exposed through public APIs.

Assessment forms

Quizzes, exams, finals, writing assignments, discussions, cases, practicals, extra credit, test-out exams, and standardized forms have published points, weights, timing, attempts, permitted materials, accommodations, integrity rules, grading method, feedback schedule, and appeal rights. Extra credit cannot be required and cannot substitute for demonstrating a required outcome. Test-out credit uses a separately approved secure form and does not imply transferability.

Proctoring

Proctoring is risk-based, privacy-minimizing, accommodation-aware, and disclosed before enrollment. Identity checks, live review, recording, automated flags, retention, vendor access, incident response, and alternate arrangements require policy and contract approval. An automated flag is not proof of misconduct. A trained human reviews evidence before action, and the student receives notice and appeal rights.

Student Services Department Operations Manual

****Status:**** Controlled draft pending executive, academic, privacy, accessibility, legal, and Board adoption.

The unified Student Services Division contains Admissions; Enrollment Services; Registrar; Academic Advising; Counseling and Student Success; Social Services; Financial Aid Readiness; Bursar and Student Billing; Institutional Accounting; and University Administration. Each department has documented authority, position descriptions, minimum qualifications, supervision, service targets, escalation paths, confidentiality controls, records ownership, and separation of duties.

Intake and communications

Every contact receives a correlation identifier, requester type, verified contact channel, department, topic, subject, message, urgency, consent version, accessibility request, source, timestamps, assigned employee, status, service target, internal notes, approved responses, attachments, delivery events, and closure reason. Public forms never request SSNs, tax records, payment credentials, diagnosis details, identity documents, or authentication secrets. Sensitive communications move to the authenticated portal.

Outbound material statements, aid eligibility decisions, account credits/refunds, record changes, policy exceptions, liability admissions, crisis communications, and public statements require authorized human approval. AI may classify, summarize, recommend knowledge, translate, and draft; it may not decide admission, aid, academic standing, billing relief, disability accommodation, crisis disposition, discipline, or credential status.

Counseling and social services

Student-success counseling is educational support unless licensed clinical services are separately established. Emergency statements receive clear emergency-service routing. Social-service referrals require informed consent, minimum-necessary data, verified providers, follow-up, and documented closure. The institution does not guarantee third-party eligibility or availability.

Financial aid and billing

Financial Aid Readiness provides information and document-planning only until institutional Title IV eligibility and approved systems are verified. No FAFSA transaction, ISIR, packaging, award, disbursement, return-of-funds calculation, or NSLDS reporting is enabled by this draft. Billing ledgers use immutable entries, dual approval for credits/refunds/write-offs, reconciliation, aging, close controls, and audit evidence. Live payment processing remains disabled.

University Personnel, Communications, and Document Control Manual

****Status:**** Draft. No listed appointment, credential, mailbox, seal, stamp, or communications channel is active solely because it appears in this manual.

Human positions require an approved job description, minimum qualifications, verified CV/credential profile, decision authority, conflicts disclosure, supervisor, appointment record, security training, and periodic evaluation. AI personas are software assistants, never employees, licensed professionals, voting faculty, trustees, or final decision-makers. Their directories state purpose, data boundary, allowed tools, escalation owner, and human-approval rule.

Role mailbox names are reserved in the application directory but are not operational until the email administrator provisions them, configures authentication and retention, assigns delegates, tests inbound and outbound delivery, and records verification. Notification channels remain disabled until provider, consent, opt-out, template, delivery, retry, suppression, incident, and audit controls pass.

Letterhead, seals, stamps, signature blocks, and watermarks are controlled assets. Draft assets cannot claim accreditation, government recognition, degree authority, licensure approval, or an unverified officer signature. Every generated document records template version, data snapshot, author, approver, output hash, issuance state, recipient, delivery event, replacement, void, and retention class.

The student communication library contains 76 controlled templates spanning inquiry, admissions, enrollment, registration, attendance, advising, progress, standing, grading, integrity, assessment, accommodations, social-service referrals, financial-aid readiness, student billing, transcripts, record corrections, graduation, and conferment. Each remains a draft until its owning office, counsel where necessary, accessibility reviewer, and authorized approver release the exact language.

Governance and Academic Forms

Board resolution

Resolution number; meeting date; authority; recitals; resolved actions; conditions; responsible officer; funding; effective date; review/expiration; vote; recusals; chair signature; secretary attestation; exhibits.

Presidential directive

Directive number; title; purpose; authority; scope; definitions; policy/action; responsibilities; controls; reporting; effective date; expiration/review; legal/fiscal/technology impact; President signature.

Curriculum minutes

Committee; meeting ID; date/time; participants; quorum; conflicts; proposal ID; evidence; discussion summary; motion; vote; conditions; effective term; owner; deadlines; approval signature.

Course proposal

Identity; description; credits/time; prerequisites; rationale; outcomes; program map; weekly outline; resources; assessments; faculty; accessibility; modality; technology/AI/privacy; cost; approvals.

Program proposal

Award; authority; need; admissions; completion; sequence; outcomes; curriculum map; faculty; library; services; assessment; budget; enrollment; consumer disclosures; authorization/accreditation; teach-out; approvals.

Faculty credential review

Faculty ID; appointment; courses; degrees/transcripts; licenses; experience; teaching evidence; equivalency rationale; verifier; conflicts; approval; limits; review date.

Student record correction

Request ID; student; record; current value; requested value; basis; evidence; privacy classification; faculty/department decision; Registrar verification; decision; appeal; immutable audit event.

Graduation audit and conferment

Student/program/catalog; credits; GPA; courses; residency; practicum; capstone; standing; holds; authority; records verification; human reviewers; award date; credential ID; Registrar certification.